modern day Okchon. The Baekje state attempted to take back its lands that Silla had seized earlier. The Baekje army was brutally defeated and 30,000 soldiers were killed. This battle also marked the death of their ruler King Song.

Political structure and government habits remained very similar as time passed. The king ruled with the help of senior administrators and officials from the aristocratic class. The provinces were further administrated by tribal leaders appointed by the central government who collected taxes from the regions. Sometimes, the central government would take payment in the form of men to help construct defensive structures. Slaves were very much part of Korean culture and were usually captured during times of warfare. Criminals and people who were deeply in debt could also be made slaves. The slaves worked for the aristocracy, tended their lands and were paid meager wages or none at all. The people were divided into various social classes. The class structure was ultimately based on Silla's bone rank system where one's birth determined the class. Taxes were calculated based on the type of work and the birth status of an individual.

The three kingdoms and the fourth state were forced to set aside their internal problems and concentrate on a new threat: the Chinese invasion from the north. The Chinese attempted to invade Goguryeo in the 7th century CE during the Sui and the Tang Dynasties. Their strategy was to raid various points of the border simultaneously. Goguryeo saw through this strategy and was able to plan ambushes at weak points across the border. Ultimately, the Chinese were unsuccessful. In 644 CE, the Tang Dynasty of China tried to invade once more but General Yang Manchun of Goguryeo was victorious in rebuffing the attack. Goguryeo allied itself with Baekje after China formed a treaty with Silla to conquer Goguryeo and Baekje. Silla quickly raised an army of 50,000 men under the command of General Kim Yushin and waited for the command to attack. Along with a navy of 130,000 men sent from China, Silla was eventually able to defeat Baekje. Uija, the king of Baekje, was taken to China against his will after the battle.

Pyongyang collapsed seven years later after suffering a crushing defeat. One year later, King Pojang of Goguryeo and 200,000 of his people were